GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

ISSUE 6

GALLIONS grapevine

November 2001

Gallions Ecopark in Thamesmead

People wishing to visit the Ecopark should call Andy Pennell of Gallions Housing Association on 020 8320 3436.
Gallions has also set up a website at **www.gallionsecopark.co.uk,** which contains more information, photographs and over the next few months on-line registration for the Visitor Centre and Naked House.





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Christmas opening hours

The office will be closed from 5pm on Friday 21 December 2001 and will reopen on Thursday 27 December 2001.



Left: *Tony Robinson on site with Wilmott Dixon overlooking the Gallions Ecopark Site.*
Below: *from left to right Tony Cotter, John Austin M and John Fahy.*





Tony Robinson joining in a musical workshop with children from Linton Mead School.

Blackadder star launches eco-friendly park

Tony Robinson, alias Baldrick from 'Blackadder', officially launched the on-site opening of the new Gallions Ecopark in Thamesmead recently.

The actor also took part in a workshop with local children from Linton Mead and St John Fisher schools.

The environmentally friendly Ecopark is a development of 39 houses and 8 flats due for completion in August 2002. The block of flats will, for the first year, also house a Visitors' Centre where schoolchildren, students, professionals and members of the general public can see how the Ecopark development has harnessed the very latest in environmentally sustainable design, construction and recycling techniques. Visitors will also be able to see a "Naked" house and take part in interactive activities. Tilfen will subsequently use all the flats for housing.

Tony Cotter, Chief Executive of Gallions Housing Association, said: "These are real homes for real people, but we also want to encourage others to see how, for example, fuel bills can be reduced by 50% with the use of these techniques. Clearly, these savings not only benefit the environment but also the tenants who pay the bills! Tenants will receive training on the most energy efficient use of their Eco homes".

Funded by Gallions Housing Association, the scheme has Demonstration Project Status, awarded by the Housing Forum, and a Housing Corporation Innovation and Good Practice Grant of £45, 000 to be used on monitoring energy consumption and 'spreading the word'. Developed in conjunction with Dutch engineers, the scheme hopes to be the largest project to date to be awarded an 'Excellent' rating against the British EcoHomes Assessment scale.

See back page for your list of contacts

Open Letter to all tenants from the Housing Corporation

The Inspectors are visiting

THE HOUSING CORPORATION

Housing Inspectors will be visiting Gallions for two weeks, starting on 7 January 2002.

We are employed by the Housing Corporation, which is responsible for checking that housing associations are providing good services for tenants. We will be meeting staff and tenants to ask whether the association meets the Housing Corporation's requirements for providing a good quality housing service and whether the service is improving. The results will assist the Board of Gallions and the senior management team to continue to improve the service.

The Inspection will involve listening to those of you who are involved in improving service delivery already and any others of you who have comments. During the Inspection we shall also be meeting groups of tenants and staff to ask them what they think about the service your landlord provides in relation to:

- **repairs and maintenance;**
- **lettings and transfers;**
- **nuisance and anti-social behaviour;**
- **black people, women, older people, people with disabilities;**
- **customer services and complaints;**
- **involving tenants;**
- **environmental and employment/training issues.**

Gallions staff will be inviting some of you to volunteer to meet us or speak to us over the phone. We have not got time to meet all of you , but we do need to hear from a wide section of tenants - black tenants, women, older people, younger people, tenants with young children, tenants with disabilities. Contact the Customer Response Centre at Gallions on 0800 83 84 81 if you would like to attend one of the meetings or be part of a telephone survey.

We are looking forward to working with you over the coming weeks.

Manpreet Dillon - *Inspection Manager*

The Housing Corporation
Waverley House, Noel Street
London W1F 8BA



Freepost Service

We are delighted to announce our new Freepost Service provided for our tenants and leaseholders.

To make full use of this service, which was launched in September 2001, please quote the following address on all correspondence to our office stating, where possible, the name or department you are contacting:

Gallions Housing Association
Freepost SE6691
London SE2 9BR

See back page for your list of contacts

New household contents insurance offer







We know that contents insurance can be expensive - but it does provide important cover. That is why we have developed a household contents scheme just for our tenants and leaseholders, in partnership with Jardine Lloyd Thompson.

We have negotiated a reduced premium that is affordable and accessible. It will let you make a choice as to whether you wish to insure your home and belongings. The scheme also offers flexible payment methods at a fixed rate for all postcode addresses in Thamesmead.

If you would like an information pack and application form please call our **Customer Response Centre** on **0800 838481** during normal working hours. The information pack provides contact details on who to ring for individual insurance advice.





Sum Insured	Fortnightly Premium at any Post Office	Monthly Premium by Direct Debit	Annually by Cheque, Postal Order, Credit/Debit Card
£6,000	£2.23	£3.64	£43.68
£7,000	£2.51	£4.25	£50.96
£8,000	£2.79	£4.85	£58.24
£9,000	£3.07	£5.46	£65.52
£10,000	£3.35	£6.07	£72.80
£11,000	£3.63	£6.67	£80.08
£12,000	£3.91	£7.28	£87.36
£13,000	£4.19	£7.89	£94.64
£14,000	£4.47	£8.49	£101.92
£15,000	£4.75	£9.10	£109.20
£16,000	£5.03	£9.71	£116.48
£17,000	£5.31	£10.31	£123.76
£18,000	£5.59	£10.92	£131.04
£19,000	£5.87	£11.53	£138.32
£20,000	£6.15	£12.13	£145.60
£21,000	£6.43	£12.74	£152.88
£22,000	£6.71	£13.35	£160.16
£23,000	£6.99	£13.95	£167.44
£24,000	£7.27	£14.56	£174.72
£25,000	£7.55	£15.17	£182.00
£26,000	£7.83	£15.77	£189.28
£27,000	£8.11	£16.38	£196.56
£28,000	£8.39	£16.99	£203.84
£29,000	£8.67	£17.59	£211.12
£30,000	£8.95	£18.20	£218.40

Highlighted figures only available for people aged over 60

These costs include Insurance Premium Tax at the current rate, and transaction charges for the fortnightly payments.



All Change for Landscaping & Cleaning Services

Over the summer, as part of our commitment to improve the services provided to you, we invited contractors to bid for the task of managing all of the day-to-day environmental work that is carried out in Thamesmead.

This includes:

- **Landscaping**
- **Cleaning**
- **Window cleaning**
- **Vehicle removal**
- **Landlord's lighting**
- **Canal and lake maintenance**

We had hoped to combine all of these into one contract but none of the companies that tendered met our requirements. We decided – in line with the views of tenants involved in the process - that we should not accept second best. As a result, we brought the landscaping and cleaning services under our own management from November 1st 2001. The other contracts will be looked at once the new set up is working smoothly.

So, how will things change? Currently, the cleaning workers are split into teams each managed by supervisors. We will sign off the work as the teams move round the estates. This means that we can monitor the work closely and improve the service straight away.

We know that this is only the start and are determined to continue to improve these services over the coming months. Please bear with us!

From Tump to Tulips



Tump 47 in Manorway Green, an old munitions store left over from the days of the Arsenal, has been transformed as part of a new initiative from Ridgeway Estate Management Board.

As part of the transformation, children from Bishop John Robinson school planted 2000 bulbs in an around part of Manorway Green. The Tump has been at the centre of the project and has become an exciting play space for young children. Its imaginative design includes a bridge with colourful art panels, swings, a slide and roundabout, together with bright safety surfacing, improved lighting and seating.

The children, whose school playground borders the Green, have been involved from the beginning. After providing some imaginative ideas for the scheme, they also helped Groundwork's Education Officer, Mike Keogh, identify trees and plants for signs. Mike said: "the children have shown a huge amount of interest in the Green – especially its history and the nature. These play facilities bring a new dimension to the area for younger children and will give them an extra treat on the way to and from school."

Gallions Housing Association and Groundwork Thames Gateway London South funded the scheme, through its Single Regeneration Budget programme – 'Vital Centres and Green Links'.

So, look out for those bulbs turning into thousands of spring flowers!

Trees for Thamesmead

If you would like to become a Trees for Thamesmead Volunteer, please contact us at Groundwork for an information pack:

Liz Cameron and Alistair Macleod

Trees for Thamesmead
Groundwork
Thames Gateway
London South
Brockley Grove Depot
Brockley
London SE4 1QX

Telephone: 020 8691 8002

Partners in Trees for Thamesmead include Thamesmead residents and Gallions Housing Association. The project aims to improve the environment of the Thamesmead area.

Imagine tree-lined streets and industrial areas screened from view. Your involvement is at the heart of the Trees for Thamesmead project. By helping us find sites for planting, such as gardens, car parks, school grounds, business areas and open spaces, you will be creating a greener and healthier Thamesmead.

Trees planted in Thamesmead will offer many benefits to local residents:

- Clean the air
- Help make the area look beautiful
- Reduce the noise from traffic
- Create shade to keep you cool during the summer
- Act as windbreaks during the cold season
- Bring more birds and wildlife into the area
- Help reduce flood risks during heavy rainfalls

Anyone who lives or works in Thamesmead and the surrounding area can be involved in this exciting project. You can help by:

- Sharing your ideas at community planning meetings
- Becoming a Trees for Thamesmead Volunteer
- Planting trees in your neighbourhood and helping them grow
- Spreading the word

MP brings transport boss to Thamesmead

Dave Wetzel, Vice-chair of Transport for London, visited Thamesmead, Abbey Wood and Belvedere in July, at the invitation of local MP, John Austin.

John Austin said: "I wanted Dave Wetzel to see first hand the radical changes in the area and the scale of the recent and proposed developments. It was also an opportunity to discuss some of the current public transport problems."

Since then, Gallions Housing Association, Tilfen and Trust Thamesmead have commissioned a travel survey of the Thamesmead and Abbey Wood area. The survey is currently under way and, once key travel patterns have been analysed, a series of projects will be identified to improve travel in the area.

Tony Cotter, Chief Executive of Gallions Housing Association, said: "Thamesmead is an area which is changing rapidly and the local transport system needs to change to meet peoples' everyday travel needs."



Dave Wetzel, Vice-chair of Transport for London with local MP, John Austin and Counsellor Peter Kotz.

"He will Thunder them from Heaven"



Albert Devereux

On Friday 19 October, a bench in Thamesmead town centre was officially unveiled in memory of the late Albert Devereux.

Albert was a board member of Thamesmead Town and Gallions Housing Association from April 1996 to March 2000.

Contributions were co-ordinated by the Gallions Charity Shop and they would like to express their appreciation to all who made donations, including Gallions Housing Association and Tilfen Ltd.

Jean Kett

Our friend and work colleague Jean Kett passed away last month. She will be deeply missed by all who knew her.

This place has seen many faces,
but none so warm as Jean's
These walls have heard many voices,
yet none so happy as Jean's
These people have met many others,
yet none so sweet as Jean.
These desks have witnessed many scenes,
but none in anger from our good friend Jean.
These floors play host to many events,
yet none so rich without Jean.
These windows shed light on many dramas,
yet none in poor light with Jean.
We people will do many things,
but from now on, without Jean.
A brighter, bigger, better star has now formed,
it is we are proud to say – by no small means –
that this star is Jean's.

Results of the Board Meeting of 18th Oct 2001

The Gallions Housing Association Board met on the 18th October and wishes to publish the following information.

a) Changes to landscaping and cleaning services, see page 4.
b) Affordable residents contents insurance, see page 3.
c) The Queen's jubilee, Gallions working in partnership with Trust Thamesmead will be making arrangements to celebrate the jubilee in June next year. Thamesmead will be one of only 10 sites across the country to have a beacon which will be on Gallions Hill. There are to be three days of celebrations including a street party.
d) Best value and regulation visit from the Housing Corporation in January, see page 2.

Board Meetings

Gallions Housing Association's Board of Management meets on a regular basis. The meetings are open to all residents.

In order to accommodate any residents who wish to attend, you would need to contact Averyl Richards at our offices, (address below) prior to any meeting to make arrangements.

The dates of the next meetings are:

13th Dec 2001

21 March 2002

13 June 2002

All meetings are held at Gallions Housing Association offices, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH at 6.30pm.

FEEDBACK

What do you think of "Gallions Grapevine"? Have you any comments on our service – good or bad? What is your view of living in Thamesmead?

Let us know by writing to **FEEDBACK, Gallions Grapevine, c/o Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH.**

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將這文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐ *(please tick one)*

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Return to: Caroline Wilson (Translation Requests), Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contacts

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London SE2 9XH

Main Switchboard
(for housing and other enquiries)
020 8310 1500

Repairs Freephone
0800 838481

Comfort 2000 Heating
020 8320 3422

Interserve
0800 389 0154